Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

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Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen's US exec exits — what it means for its America play

Adyen just lost a senior US executive, and while people changes happen, this one matters because North America is the company's biggest battleground. The US is where Adyen faces Stripe, PayPal/ Braintree and Block head-on, and where enterprise deals depend heavily on long sales cycles and deep relationships. An executive exit can introduce near term noise—think account handovers, pipeline re checks and a little talent risk—without changing the core story: Adyen's single, global platform and unified commerce pitch remain intact. After its 2023 wobble on growth and margins, Adyen has rebuilt credibility by focusing on large merchants and disciplined pricing. The question now is whether US momentum keeps up without a familiar face leading the charge. For merchants, the rails don't change—payments will keep flowing. For investors, watch the next couple of quarters for signals: new logo wins, enterprise churn, and North America volume growth. If those stay healthy, this is routine succession. If they slip, rivals will smell opportunity. Net-net: the strategy is steady; execution in the US just got a little more important.

Source: PaymentsDive
https://www.paymentsdive.com/news/adyen-us-executive-exits/805752/

Article 2

Adyen pushes deeper into embedded finance to boost platform stickiness

Adyen just signaled it's not content with being "only" a payments processor. The Dutch fintech is broadening its toolkit for platforms and marketplaces with embedded financial services — think native payouts, business accounts and data-driven financing delivered under the platform's brand while Adyen handles the heavy regulatory lifting behind the scenes. What does this mean? Payments is a tight-margin game, and the real money lies in value-added services that raise take rates and keep merchants glued to your ecosystem. By moving further into embedded finance, Adyen is monetizing more of the transaction lifecycle, leveraging its banking capabilities, and trading commoditized processing for stickier, higher-ARPU relationships. For platforms, it's a chance to simplify vendor sprawl and ship finance features faster — but with deeper integration and compliance considerations. For competitors, it's a shot across the bow: Stripe, Block and BaaS providers will feel the heat as merchants look for a one-stop shop. Bottom line: the PSP playbook is evolving. Payments get you in the door; embedded finance helps you own the house.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/

Article 3

Adyen teams up with Plaid to push pay by bank at checkout

Adyen is joining forces with Plaid to make paying straight from your bank account a lot easier. Plaid brings the pipes—secure account linking, instant balance checks, and risk signals—while Adyen wraps it into its acquiring and processing stack. The result? Merchants can offer pay by bank/ACH alongside cards, with lower acceptance costs and fewer chargebacks, without turning checkout into a science project. This matters because card fees are stubborn, fraud is pricey, and open banking rails are finally usable at scale. For Adyen, it's a way to deepen control of the checkout and hedge against a card heavy world. For Plaid, it's more volume flowing through its data pipes. Expect billers, subscription players, and marketplaces to be early adopters. The catch: ACH isn't instant or irreversible, so risk management and smart nudges are critical to shift consumer habit. If Adyen can package this into a slick one click flow (and maybe dangle incentives), watch pay by bank inch up share at checkout—and watch card economics feel a little more heat.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/

Article 4

Adyen leans into BNPL as holiday checkouts heat up

Buy now, pay later (BNPL) is set for another holiday growth spurt, and Adyen wants to be the gateway. The Dutch payments processor is pushing wider BNPL access at checkout—think Swedish heavyweight Klarna among others—so merchants can catch cautious shoppers without the sticker shock. What's the payoff? Typically, better conversion and bigger baskets for retailers, and more processing volume for Adyen. Because Adyen doesn't underwrite the loans, it dodges most credit risk while still becoming stickier to merchants that want one integration for cards, wallets and installments. But it's not all free candy. BNPL tends to carry higher merchant fees than cards, refund and dispute flows can be messy, and regulators in the EU and UK are circling with tighter rules that could dent growth or raise compliance costs. The bigger picture: checkout is a land grab. If Adyen makes BNPL plug-and-play and proves the uplift is real this season, it strengthens its "one-stop" pitch versus rivals —from acquirers to fintechs—while giving retailers a timely tool to nudge hesitant shoppers over the line.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/

Article 5

Square debuts Handheld: a phone-free, all in one POS for busy merchants

Square made its name by plugging a tiny reader into your smartphone. Now it's yanking the phone out of the picture. The company's new "Handheld" is a compact, all in one POS device that bundles payments, software, and connectivity into a single unit—no attachments, no BYOD headaches. Think of it as Square's answer to mobile checkout chaos in restaurants, retail floors, and curbside setups. What does this mean? First, reliability and control. Staff no longer juggle personal phones and dongles, and IT teams get a managed device tied tightly into Square's ecosystem. Second, strategy. As tap to pay on smartphones eats into the need for accessories, Square is hedging with dedicated hardware that deepens merchant lock in and boosts hardware and SaaS revenue per location. Third, competition. This puts Square toe to toe with Toast Go, Clover Flex, and other rugged mobile POS units aimed at high velocity environments. For merchants, it's less friction at checkout and potentially faster tableside turns; for Square, more processing volume secured at the edge and a stronger moat —albeit with the usual hardware inventory and support costs attached.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/

Article 6

Square brings Bitcoin to the checkout counter

Square is adding bitcoin payment capabilities for its merchants — a timely nudge as small businesses feel pressure to adopt "what's next" without hiring a crypto team. The pitch is simple: let customers pay in bitcoin at the point of sale or online and let Square handle the messy bits in the background. For merchants, that could mean tapping into a new, vocal customer base and a marketing halo, with the possibility of better economics on some transactions. The flip side? Volatility, refunds, and tax/accounting treatment still need careful handling, and compliance rules differ by market. For Square, it's on-brand and strategic. Block (Square's parent) has long bet on bitcoin, and this move helps keep sellers inside its ecosystem rather than losing crypto-curious merchants to niche processors. It also counters rivals like PayPal and Shopify that have been flirting with crypto rails. Big picture: card networks won't feel an immediate hit, but cross-border, digital goods, and high-ticket niches will test whether crypto can shave costs or expand reach. If Square abstracts the complexity well, bitcoin at checkout shifts from a gimmick to a pragmatic option on the payment menu.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/

Article 7

Square serves its first Bitcoin POS payment at D.C. coffee shop

A Compass Coffee in Washington, D.C. just rang up a latte with bitcoin—using Square's new point-of-sale. It's a small sip, but it shows Block is nudging crypto out of the app and into the checkout counter. For merchants, the real story isn't HODLing; it's whether the POS auto-converts BTC to dollars, settles fast, and keeps fees predictable. If Square can make crypto payments feel like card taps—clear pricing, minimal fraud exposure, and quick settlement—acquirers and gateways will need to pay attention. Volumes will be tiny to start: consumers still face tax headaches and price swings. But flipping on acceptance across thousands of terminals creates a "why not" option for crypto-native customers and high-margin venues. Compliance and accounting still loom large, so merchants will want clean reporting and AML comfort baked in. For Square, the pilot is a strategic flex—deeper merchant lock-in, multi-rail acceptance, and brand alignment with bitcoin. Bottom line: it's not the coffee, it's the plumbing. If bitcoin becomes just another rail in mainstream POS, payments economics —fees, risk, and settlement—could see a quiet rewrite.

Source: PaymentsJournal

https://www.paymentsjournal.com/squares-platform-sees-first-bitcoin-payment-at-coffee-shop/